MyScoutee

MYSCOUTEE TRILOGY

I

VOLUME ONE
OF THE TRILOGY

The Story

The City Between Us

A founder's memoir of rooms, routes, and the path between people

DRAFT V0.1 · NOT YET PUBLISHED · UPDATED 2026-08-07

MyScoutee

I

VOLUME ONE OF THE MYSCOUTEE TRILOGY

The Story

The City Between Us

A founder's memoir of rooms, routes, and the path between people

DRAFT V0.1 · NOT YET PUBLISHED · UPDATED 2026-08-07

An unpublished first-person review draft. Autobiographical memory is kept distinct from verified product capability and future product outcomes.

Contents

A Note to the Reader

Prologue — The Cognac Notebook

PART ONE — GROUND

1. What the Soil Teaches
2. Budapest, Beautiful and Distant
3. The Key My Parents Gave Me

PART TWO — THE HOUSE INSIDE LONDON

4. The City Opened in Two Stages
5. The Performance of Not Being Hungry
6. Thirteen Hungarian Lives
7. The Stranger Who Snored
8. The First Three Years and the Fifth

PART THREE — GLOBAL ROUTES, LOCAL ENCOUNTERS

9. The Fare Was One Pound
10. The Extra Day Nobody Had
11. Forty Countries, No Collection
12. Egypt: Six Days of Temporary Trust
13. India in a Cash Discontinuity
14. Thailand, Cambodia, and the Price of a Ride
15. Moscow, Saint Petersburg, and an Open Gate
16. Europe Within Reach
17. Empty Beds, Empty Seats, Perfect Systems
18. When the World Closed

PART FOUR — ROOMS FULL OF BEGINNINGS

19. I Came Home to Find a Partner
20. Two Kinds of Silence
21. Rooms Full of Beginnings
22. The Beginner Floor
23. The Wrong Room for a Date
24. A Whole Person Behind the Frame

PART FIVE — DRAWING THE PATH

25. The Idea from 2016
26. Priority Is Not Human Value
27. Six Strangers
28. The First Managed Event
29. After Strangers Become Known
30. One Shared Core, Many Local Souls
31. What Is Built, What Is Not Proven

Epilogue — The Star Above the Open Space

NOTES ON MEMORY, GEOGRAPHY, AND PRODUCT TRUTH

Budapest and Its Surroundings

Thiruvananthapuram and the First India Assignment

London, Migration, and Return

Selected Journey Anchors

Age and Digital Dating

Product Claims

A Note to the Reader

This is a memoir-based account told in the first person. It is also the origin story of a product that is still being tested.

The rooms, journeys, conversations, mistakes and moments of kindness come from my memory. Names have been removed, some sequences have been compressed, and a few uncertain locations remain deliberately unnamed. Where memory and public geography meet, I prefer an honest question mark to invented precision.

This story compresses decades. Adjacent pages, and especially adjacent seconds in the companion film, do not necessarily describe events from the same year or events that followed one another immediately. Where a year changes the meaning, I state it. Where only the emotional connection matters, I preserve the bridge without pretending that a lifetime happened in one continuous season.

MyScoutee is a built software core, not a claim of proven social outcomes. It does not promise a perfect partner, guaranteed chemistry or complete safety. The idea is simpler and more difficult: help mutual intention travel far enough to become a real, freely chosen meeting.

This review draft ends with that invitation. It does not contain the later legal and documentary chapter of my life.

Prologue — The Cognac Notebook

The notebook is still on my desk.

Its cover is the colour of cognac held against a window at dusk: brown until the light reaches it, amber where the years have worn the surface smooth. I carried it through rooms that never quite became homes, opened it on trains and buses, and filled it with systems long before I knew which system I was trying to build. Some pages contain numbers. Some contain routes. Others contain sentences that stop halfway across the paper, as if they too were waiting for somebody to answer.

When I look back now, I do not remember my life as a straight line. A village field becomes a railway track. The railway becomes a tram wire over Budapest. The wire becomes the blue-white route of the Victoria line. A wet London window becomes the glass of a bus somewhere between mountains. A pencil mark becomes a network.

Memory edits without asking permission.

Yet one question survives every cut: how can a world crowded with people leave so many of us without a path to one another?

That question did not begin with an app. It began much earlier, with soil on the hands of my family, three disciplines in my mind, a diploma still waiting behind one missing language certificate, a city of extraordinary beauty, and the strange discovery that a person can have a place to sleep without having a place in life.

MYSCOUTEE ORIGIN STORY

Part One — Ground

1. What the Soil Teaches

My ancestors were small agricultural producers. I do not say this to construct a romantic countryside that never existed. The soil is not sentimental. It is seasonal, physical and exact. Something is planted or it is not. Rain comes or does not come. Work leaves a mark that can be seen.

That inheritance stayed with me even when my own tools became mathematics and software. I trusted systems that could be understood, work that could be tested, and effort that produced a visible result. I was less prepared for the invisible systems surrounding human acceptance: the rooms offered through friendship, the jobs decided through impressions, the circles that opened only when somebody inside already knew your name.

Like many young people from the countryside, I moved toward Budapest for study and work. It was not because the countryside had no dignity, and it was not because every Hungarian journey must end in the capital. It was my route. The station platform was small; the expectation attached to it was enormous.

I studied economics, programming and mathematics together. In Hungarian, the degree has a name that sounds almost like three professions trying to occupy one line. I liked that. Economics asked what people valued. Mathematics asked what could be proven. Programming asked whether an idea could be made to run.

Years later, MyScoutee would need all three questions.

2. Budapest, Beautiful and Distant

Budapest never looked like a city one should need to escape.

The Danube divides it and holds it together. From the Pest side, Buda rises in layers: Castle Hill, stone walls, church towers and slopes that catch the last light. From Buda, Pest opens into boulevards, tram lines and the long ceremonial geometry of Andrássy Avenue. Yellow trams move beside the river as if somebody had drawn a bright line through history. Steam rises from thermal water in winter. Museums, concert halls, markets, cafés and old cinemas offer more lives than one person could inhabit.

The beauty continues beyond the city. The Danube bends through Szentendre, Visegrád and Esztergom. At Visegrád, the river curves below the citadel; at Esztergom, the basilica rises above the water and the border. Gödöllő holds a palace and park close enough for a day. The Buda hills begin before the city has fully ended, with caves, forest paths and the chairlift lifting ordinary afternoons above the roofs.

I knew I came from a beautiful place. That knowledge made the loneliness more confusing, not less.

I finished university in 2004. Because my dissertation had slipped behind its original schedule, the earliest I could have collected the diploma was 2005. Even then I could not collect it: one intermediate-level foreign-language examination was still missing. In reality, I received the diploma considerably later. My first attempt to establish myself in Budapest did not become a settled move. For about a month, relatives let me stay in their large house. There was physical space, and I do not claim that they treated me badly, but I felt that I was imposing on their life. The work that had brought me there did not match what the employer had led me to expect. I felt deceived, and I returned to my parents.

After that, Budapest became a series of one-day attempts. I travelled up for job interviews several times, with the employment centre reimbursing the cost of the journey to the capital. A ticket could carry me to an interview and back, but it could not yet turn the city into a life. Each trip began with possibility and ended with another return to my parents' home.

The Cornfield and Trivandrum

The professional door finally opened in October 2005, about a year and a half after I had finished university. At that moment I was not sitting in an office or waiting beside a polished reception desk. I was hoeing between rows of corn.

I joined an Indian company that October, and almost immediately the route carried me to South India. I spent about a month and a half in Thiruvananthapuram, also known as Trivandrum, working with an Irish and Hungarian team. The city is Kerala's capital near the far southwestern edge of mainland India: low coastal hills face the Arabian Sea while the higher country of the Western Ghats rises to the east and northeast. It already belonged to an established technology landscape, but the place I encountered could not be reduced to an office or a software park.

The district includes famous visitor beaches. The particular shoreline that stayed in my memory felt very different: I practically saw no tourists there. That is a memory of one beach, not a claim that southern Kerala had no tourism. What mattered was the sudden scale of the change. A man who had just been working a cornfield was now learning how to work inside a South Indian city, with the sea at the edge of it and several national habits meeting inside one team.

That was where I began to learn English in practice. Until then, English was also the formal obstacle between me and my diploma: I still needed the intermediate-level language certificate required before I could collect it. In Trivandrum, the language became less an examination subject than the ordinary means of asking, answering, misunderstanding, correcting and completing work together. It became usable; it did not yet become easy. I do not collapse that first professional stay into my later 2016 journey through northern India. This was an earlier threshold: the first international work environment in which a missing credential began to become a usable human skill.

The Indian company opened the professional door. On paper, the sequence now looked correct: countryside, university, international work, capital city. Yet the route into stable adult life was far less legible than the route printed on any tram map.

When I first came to Budapest for work, I stayed in a workers' hostel. It was impersonal, but its impersonality had rules. A bed was a bed. A key was a key. The difficulty was that late work could bring me back after the room had been locked. On some nights, the corridor became the only remaining space. I learned how fluorescent light changes when you are trying to sleep beneath it.

Encounters Without a Reliable Room

Human possibility did not wait politely for my housing problem to end.

A woman from Debrecen came to Budapest for another commitment — perhaps some kind of lecture or presentation, although I no longer remember exactly. Before it, we spent about three hours on a date. I was strongly attracted to her. When our time was up, we walked together to the venue for the programme that had originally brought her to the city. Along the way she linked her arm through mine. At our quick goodbye she gave me a slightly shy kiss on the cheek, then went to her programme. I was living in the workers' hostel and could not offer her a place to stay, but she did not know that: I had not told her I was living in a workers' hostel. Where I left the circumstances unexplained, she formed her own picture of me and at one point described me as poor. Only later, once she was home in Debrecen, did she write to me in a chat: “You should have kissed me.” To her, the moment need not have ended with that shy cheek kiss; it could have become a real kiss.

Even a three-hour date required us to coordinate an intercity journey and the other commitment that had brought her to Budapest: when she would arrive, where we could meet, when we had to reach that programme's venue, and which return would close the available window. Attraction did not remove geography or competing plans. The journey, her purpose in the city and our time together had to fit inside one another.

The sentence remained with me because it arrived after the moment in which it could have changed anything. She eventually found a partner and moved to Budapest. About a decade later, we met again. I read anger in the way she looked at me, but I cannot know what that expression contained. Memory can preserve a face; it cannot safely invent the other person's inner account.

Another woman entered my life without an app or an introduction. In a shopping centre, she approached me, sat down beside me on a bench and began with Chinese and Western astrology. It was spontaneous, direct and almost impossible to design: a stranger created the opening herself, and conversation existed before either of us had prepared a profile.

The absence of private space still shaped what followed. Even the possibility of being together was difficult to plan. One day ended on Margaret Island: one of Budapest's most generous public spaces standing in for a private room neither the hostel nor our circumstances could provide.

Later, at her family home, a frightening family and health crisis revealed how much important context I had not known. I took a day away from work to accompany her to care in another city. The relationship ended. Her diagnosis, treatment and family details are not mine to publish. The part that belongs to my story is more limited: spontaneous attraction can be real, while needs that two unprepared people do not understand remain invisible until a crisis.

For a while, I found a private room in Budapest. I was not told that I was only replacing somebody for the summer. When the previous circle wanted the room back, the arrangement changed around me. The precise address and the people do not belong in this book. What mattered was the difference between a system I could see and acceptance I could not predict.

I returned to the workers' hostel. Its rules were strict and its atmosphere anonymous, but anonymity sometimes felt safer than a welcome that could be withdrawn without warning.

Later, I moved into an ordinary shared flat with three genuinely separate bedrooms. They were not passage rooms through which residents crossed to reach one another's space. For the first time in this sequence, the arrangement gave each person a normal boundary and enough room.

A third encounter began through an online dating site and happened there. This time the physical space existed, but a ready-made story about me arrived first. I felt immediately stereotyped. The first judgment softened enough for a single night, but not into a shared future.

There was another online introduction before London in which the other woman wanted to continue getting to know me. This time I cannot blame the room, the train or an absent shared context. I became frightened by the possibility of commitment and stepped back. That memory matters because a system did not break every unfinished path. Sometimes I was the person who closed it.

I do not present these women as mistakes or myself as the innocent centre of unfinished stories. Attraction, hesitation, dignity, money, housing, health, timing and expectation were different in every case. We all arrived with problems, and we all risked turning one visible problem into a judgment about the whole person.

A relationship is not the selection of somebody whose life contains no difficulty. It is the slower work of learning what is real and deciding whether two people can accept one another and continue through problems together. That does not mean hiding essential context, abandoning boundaries or enduring harm. It means refusing to confuse a quick label with a complete human being.

In these memories, judgment often arrived before understanding, while important context sometimes arrived too late. Mutual possibility appeared. What we lacked was enough shared truth, time and structure to discover whether we could move forward together.

3. The Key My Parents Gave Me

Eventually, my parents helped me acquire a flat.

That sentence is short enough to hide the weight inside it. Their help gave me material security at a time when many Hungarian families entered foreign-currency mortgages that later became traps. I did not take that route. I cannot know what would have happened in an alternate life, and I do not claim that every borrower made the same decision or faced the same outcome. I only know that my parents' help placed a solid key in my hand.

The key solved a housing problem. It did not solve belonging.

Budapest remained beautiful outside the window. I had work. I had an education. I had a place that was mine. I still felt that the surrounding human world was conducting a conversation from which I had missed the opening sentence.

This is one of the hardest forms of solitude to explain. Nothing is obviously wrong. The lights are on. The bridges are full. Exhibitions open, musicians play, friends meet friends, and couples find one another in ways that appear effortless from the outside. A person can live among all of it and remain unconnected.

The final work sequence before London made that separation impossible to ignore. Through my previous employer, I spent roughly four or five months working in the United States. Our temporary base was a hotel on the outskirts of Baltimore, and we had a company-rented car. The geography that opened around the work was astonishing. We reached Ocean City and Washington, travelled between Baltimore and New York by Greyhound, saw Niagara Falls, visited Amish country and an amusement park, and encountered the wooded ridges and protected landscapes that rise west of the great eastern cities.

In Adams Morgan, I remember women smiling and sometimes making the first approach. I do not turn that into conquest or a claim about American women. What stayed with me was the social lightness of the gesture: for a moment, contact did not feel like a test I had already failed.

The most surprising feeling arrived on the return from New York toward Baltimore. Somewhere on that journey, I felt for the first time that I was going home. “Home” meant a hotel outside Baltimore and a temporary working team, not a permanent address. The feeling showed how quickly repeated routes and familiar people can give borrowed geography an emotional centre.

That American period was therefore not black and white. It was a dream of scale, movement and possibility, but it contained very little private life. Work consumed most of it. In my account, I was driven extremely hard after overtime had been promised, but the promised overtime payment never arrived. I left the employer. I keep the company anonymous because this is my memory of what happened, not an adjudicated claim in this book.

What followed was six and a half months without work. The last Hungarian interview process I remember was with a small company. It continued through four rounds; the fourth included psychological testing. After all of that, the company still did not hire me. The test itself is not the accusation. What stayed with me was the expanding sequence of gates, effort and uncertainty that still ended at a closed door.

I did not leave because Budapest was ugly or empty. The unpaid promised overtime, departure from that job, six and a half months of unemployment and one last four-round rejection became the final sequence in a much longer experience of not moving forward. England was no longer simply an adventure. I experienced it as an escape toward a labour market in which I might still find a usable door.

There was also a frightening physical reason for urgency. Blood in my stool had first appeared during the extreme work pressure of the American assignment. I connected the symptom to that pressure, but this memoir does not turn my interpretation into a medical diagnosis. By the time I left for London in 2011, I was still carrying that symptom and fear. My Hungarian public-health-insurance coverage was no longer active. In London, I received medical care. I keep the diagnosis and clinical details outside this public account; the relevant truth is that the journey began with vulnerability as well as ambition.

The London ticket was not a rejection of home. It was an attempt to find a door.

MYSCOUTEE ORIGIN STORY

Part Two — The House Inside London

4. The City Opened in Two Stages

I arrived in London in 2011. The Diamond Jubilee and Olympic summer did not bring me there; they came the following year, after the first work, health and housing thresholds had already begun.

I brought one suitcase and the professional identity I understood best: I was a programmer. Despite my weak English, I found work in London within two weeks. In Soho, I wrote software in a compact office among colleagues from different countries. For almost three years, however, I could barely speak with them. Trivandrum had made English usable; London exposed how far I still was from an easy social voice.

Outside, the streets changed character every few metres. A theatre queue gave way to a record shop, a café to a private doorway, a Chinese restaurant to a small gallery. The same wet pavement reflected ten different worlds.

London did not ask me to understand it before entering. It allowed me to enter first and remain confused in public.

That was a kind of freedom.

Then, in 2012, the Diamond Jubilee and Olympic summer filled public space with temporary confidence. The city seemed to be introducing itself in every language at once. That exceptional summer became part of London's early magic, but it was not the date or reason for my arrival.

There were museums where a person could spend a day for the price of the journey, exhibitions that opened unexpected rooms in the mind, clubs, public lectures, late cafés and dates across cultures. Accents changed from desk to desk. At first, much of that human world reached me as sound before it became conversation. Humour crossed borders imperfectly and sometimes became funnier because of the effort.

Once, an Indian colleague suggested that we buy a costume animal tail as a farewell gift for a Polish colleague. We went into Soho to find it. The memory is ridiculous in exactly the right way: three nationalities are present, but none of them is the joke. The joke is that friendship can become specific very quickly when people share a task no sensible biography would predict.

For the first three years, the city felt inexhaustible.

5. The Performance of Not Being Hungry

My colleagues went out for lunch together. In Soho, lunch was not only food; it was where the workday became human. People loosened, told stories, complained, laughed and returned to their desks knowing a little more about one another.

It was also expensive.

I was afraid that London would consume my money before I had built any future there. So I performed another version of myself. When coats came off chairs and somebody asked whether I was coming, I behaved as if hunger had simply failed to arrive that day.

After the door closed, I ate muesli with milk. The two-litre bottle became a private object in a public life.

I do not blame my colleagues. I did not tell them the truth, and they had no reason to know it. That is precisely why the memory matters. Social exclusion does not always look like a door being slammed. Sometimes a person protects himself by presenting the version that costs least to explain. The performance works, and because it works, nobody sees the need underneath it.

By day, I was a competent programmer in Soho. At lunch, I disappeared while remaining in the same room.

6. Thirteen Hungarian Lives

At night, the Victoria line carried me north to Tottenham.

The journey appears only briefly in my memory: carriage glass, a reflected face, the dark tunnel interrupted by stations, then a Victorian front door. Behind that door was a converted house containing thirteen Hungarian adults: the twelve people I lived with and me.

London outside was radically multicultural. The house inside was a compressed map of Hungary.

We were not identical migrants arranged around a single explanation. One person had left after a family was damaged by a foreign-currency loan. Another came to learn English. Somebody wanted adventure. Somebody was restarting below the level of his qualifications. A night worker returned when others were leaving. A hospitality worker folded an apron beside a private plan. Someone sent money home. Someone had worked for two years and still could not save enough for the return journey he had imagined. Someone lost his money through poker and had to recalculate everything.

One full bathroom served the house, with one separate toilet. I shared a bedroom. Every shelf, mirror and quiet telephone call required negotiation.

Yet the house was not a tableau of defeat. People ironed shirts before dates, translated messages, borrowed umbrellas, studied, laughed, failed, tried again and made room for one another because there was literally no other way to move through the hall.

In my rough memory, perhaps one person in three around that household and its circle no longer wanted to return to Hungary. This is not a measured statistic; I would never print it as one. It is the emotional proportion I remember. Some kept family photographs and precise return plans. Some were undecided. Some had formed local ties. Others seemed to have stored the idea of return somewhere they no longer opened.

They could be materially poorer in London and still feel happier there.

That contradiction stayed with me. A home can preserve roots and still contain loneliness. A crowded rented room can be difficult and still contain more human life. Prosperity, shelter, home and belonging are related, but they are not the same thing.

7. The Stranger Who Snored

One night, I went to sleep sharing the room with one person and woke to the sound of another.

The change announced itself through snoring.

The flatmate who had lost his money through gambling had exchanged his place with an acquaintance. No formal transition reached me. Darkness fell on one arrangement; morning revealed another adult silhouette in the same zone of the room.

There is pain behind that story, and I do not make the debt or the person into a joke. The humour belongs to the housing system: a human life could be replaced overnight while the furniture remained more stable than the residents.

The different snore was a perfect edit. It contained loss, adaptation, embarrassment and survival in one sound.

Years later, when I thought about software that remembers whether people have actually met, I remembered how easily human context can disappear. A person can enter the same physical space without an introduction and become only evidence in the morning.

8. The First Three Years and the Fifth

The shared bedroom was a bargain I made consciously. The money saved through sharing paid for journeys while the low cost base also allowed savings to accumulate. For a time, the bargain felt temporary and therefore light.

The first three years passed in wonder. Work, museums, colleagues, nightlife, dates and low-cost travel kept opening the world faster than the room could close it.

By the fourth and fifth years, repetition changed the meaning. The same commute, the same rent, the same negotiated space and the same calculation began to look less like a bridge and more like a permanent structure. Alternative housing felt too expensive and unmanageable. That pressure mattered, but it was not the whole reason I returned, and my employer was not the enemy of the story.

What changed was my sense of time.

Temporary hardship can feel almost adventurous when the future remains open. The same hardship becomes heavy when a person realizes that the future has been waiting outside the room for years.

London had not lost its magic. I had begun to ask what the magic was building.

In December 2015, I looked again at a private diagram through which I had been tracking the route toward financial independence. This was not a projection of future independence. The diagram showed that what I had saved was enough for financial independence in Budapest.

The location mattered. Budapest was much less expensive, and the flat my parents had helped provide before London was available to me. It had stood empty throughout the five years I lived in London. In Budapest, the savings and the flat changed the calculation completely. In London, I had never been financially independent.

The London number contained a trap. I had accumulated the savings while living throughout my London years in a shared bedroom. A normal private home in London would consume too much of what I had built, while remaining in the same shared room would turn a temporary bargain into my permanent life.

Housing became my stop-loss. I use that phrase deliberately: the boundary beyond which staying would either spend away the Budapest independence I had reached or require me to keep accepting a life I could no longer inhabit.

That recognition placed me in front of my greatest fear. I had reached the financial target for a viable life in Budapest, but I could not build a viable London home around it. I left London with very little explanation. The company asked whether I wanted to make a complaint. I said no. The real reason had never been the company; it was the question of whether I could direct my own life without waiting for another institution to grant permission.

On some visits home from London, I used online dating in Budapest while hiding that London was where I actually lived. I wanted to enter the immediate local possibility without letting the distance define me first. But the distance would have defined any continuation, and withholding it prevented the other person from judging the real plan. The concealment was mine.

During that period I also met a former colleague who, in my memory, had barely noticed me while I was living in Budapest. The new encounter became intense almost immediately. She spoke in the language of love and of wanting a child before there was enough shared life for me to understand what the declaration meant. I interpreted the suddenness as a wish for motherhood attaching itself to me, rather than love growing from knowledge of me. That was my interpretation, not access to her private motive. What I can say safely is that speed without shared context frightened me, while my own hidden London life made the context less complete from the other direction too.

I sometimes imagine how different those years might have felt if a fast, group-first local path had already existed. It could not have promised me a partner or removed the price of housing. It might have helped the city's extraordinary variety become recurring human context sooner: a small local group, a shared activity, another invitation, and people who no longer vanished when one event ended.

London could have been better still—not because its magic was false, but because more of that magic might have become belonging. This is a counterfactual hope, not a product result I can prove.

In December 2015, after almost five years, I came home.

Not because the first three years had been false, but because they had been real—and were no longer enough.

MYSCOUTEE ORIGIN STORY

Part Three — Global Routes, Local Encounters

9. The Fare Was One Pound

Travel began in London as an argument with limitation.

I could not buy comfort, so I bought movement. Once, an overnight coach to Edinburgh cost one pound. The price turned sleep into an optional extra. I spent the night inside the shared atmosphere of strangers, including the unmistakable smell of somebody else's socks, and arrived in Scotland carrying fatigue as proof of admission.

I went because the adventure was larger than the inconvenience.

From Edinburgh, the country opened farther. Loch Ness replaced the contained geometry of London with water, weather and distance. On the River Clyde in Glasgow, a powerboat transformed the industrial waterfront into speed, spray and bridges. At a ticket counter, a German tourist considered the price for his child too high. For a moment I almost paid it. I had very little money, but the impulse appeared before the calculation.

Travel revealed parts of me that ordinary life kept hidden. Thrift could live beside generosity. Fear could live beside curiosity. Exhaustion could become a story before it had even ended.

This is what I mean by a global route becoming a local encounter. The map takes you somewhere. A person, a voice, a price, a misunderstanding or an unexpected act gives the place human scale.

10. The Extra Day Nobody Had

I once planned a route from London through Manchester, Liverpool, North Wales and Cardiff, then back to London.

The plan worked. That was almost the problem.

Railways and timetables connected the cities with impressive precision. In Manchester, brick, industry, libraries and new glass occupied the same streets. Liverpool opened toward the Mersey, the Pier Head and the old docks. Somewhere along the North Wales coast, two lines of hills seemed to lead the eye toward the sea. At low tide we could walk far onto the exposed shore and look back at a small village held against the slope. Llanfairfechan is now my strongest candidate for that memory, but I will not force certainty onto it. Cardiff added castle stone, arcades and the broad movement toward the bay.

Everything happened on time. Everything happened too quickly.

Nobody travelling with me could take one additional day away from work. The missing day compressed a beautiful circuit into an exercise in endurance. The transport system had capacity. The places had capacity. Our lives did not.

Years later, when I designed a path in which one invited person could decline and another could freely accept an available place, I remembered this journey. The point was never to replace friends as if people were spare parts. The point was to admit that willingness and availability are different facts. A plan can fail even when everybody likes the idea. A humane system should preserve the relationship and still allow the event to live.

11. Forty Countries, No Collection

Over the years I reached almost forty countries across Europe, Asia and the Americas.

The number is true and almost meaningless by itself.

Countries are not achievements to be collected, and monuments are not evidence that a person understood a place. My strongest memories are often thresholds: somebody explains a route; a driver waits; a passenger makes space; a vendor changes tone; a host points toward what the postcard does not show; a stranger notices danger before I do; a group cooperates because a balloon has landed in the wrong field.

In each new environment, I met a different version of myself. Cairo tested my ability to negotiate. India tested what remained possible when cash suddenly lost its ordinary meaning. Thailand tested my reading of offers and kindness. Russia tested my patience with official routes and my dependence on an ordinary local gesture. Norway tested my willingness to trust a chain of transport I did not control. London had begun the movement, but returning to Budapest did not end it. Some of my largest journeys came later.

The notebook therefore does not preserve a strict timeline. It preserves a principle:

> *Global route. Local encounter.*

The route expands the world. The encounter makes it real. In the difference between the two, I discover something about myself.

12. Egypt: Six Days of Temporary Trust

I planned six days in Egypt largely by myself. Through WhatsApp, local hotels and drivers, I assembled four days along the southern Nile. The itinerary was short enough to look unreasonable and precise enough to work.

In Cairo, I entered a landscape whose scale had already lived in my imagination for years. At Giza, a camel ride became a dispute over money. Even signs around the site tried to make expected prices legible, yet I still felt I had been overcharged. I walked back with the concentration of somebody trying not to turn embarrassment into anger.

A manager noticed. A photograph of the camel became evidence in an improvised search. For a time, I sat between two serious armed tourism-security officers while they tried to identify the person. Eventually I returned in a police vehicle to ask for part of the money back.

I do not tell this as a judgment on Egyptian vendors or a claim that the country was inherently dangerous. I tell it because the route through the problem depended on strangers who decided the problem was worth their time.

Another Cairo memory began at the airport. A taxi driver told me that official exchange points were behind an unofficial market. I found his proposed ride too expensive and ended up sharing transport with a Sudanese married couple. A playful conversation began. I found myself drawn to the woman; the couple seemed amused by the transparent awkwardness of it. Then the taxi moved, the suitcases stacked on its roof fell, and whatever social performance had been forming was replaced by a practical crisis.

The luggage hit the ground. We acquired a common story immediately.

In Luxor, I stayed outside the usual centre on the west bank of the Nile. In one direction lay the landscape of tombs and desert. Across the water, the lights of Luxor trembled in the river. Serious armed men watched over a tourism economy still recovering from years of fear. Ancient stone, ordinary livelihood and security occupied the same frame.

At dawn, I went up in a hot-air balloon. It did not land where a clean tourism brochure would have chosen. It came down in a vegetable plot. A wall complicated the exit. Some passengers had to pass through a private home while residents, crew and travellers worked together to remove the balloon across the boundary.

For a few minutes, nationality was less important than where to put one's hands.

On my last day, I did not want to exchange more Egyptian pounds. I still wanted a small souvenir for my mother and needed enough money to reach the airport. A taxi driver proposed a simple equation: whatever I could bargain off the vendor's price would remain available for the fare.

The journey was full of such temporary networks. A hotel, a driver, a manager, a security officer, a resident, a taxi passenger—each carried me across one threshold, then disappeared from the route. The experience was rich precisely because people mattered. It was fragile because the connection had no memory.

13. India in a Cash Discontinuity

In November 2016, I flew through Dubai for a five-day journey to India. Roughly three days were available on the ground for the Golden Triangle; the rest belonged to airports and transfers.

That month, the existing high-value 500- and 1,000-rupee notes were withdrawn from ordinary legal-tender use. A technical decision at national scale became a human problem in every queue. People waited at cash machines. Others were paid to hold places. Exchange became uncertain. My own driver,

coordinated through WhatsApp, sometimes became the person from whom I had to ask for entrance money.

The arrangement reversed the expected roles. I was the visitor, but I was not financially autonomous. The driver was providing transport and, for moments, liquidity.

Delhi, Agra and Jaipur did not merge into one postcard. Each had its own density, colour, traffic, stone and pace. At the Taj Mahal, another memory separated itself from the architecture. A young woman was travelling with her grandfather. On the bus behind me, I heard a pleasant voice. I turned and, for a moment, lost the ability to arrange language into anything intelligent.

We spoke briefly.

Nothing dramatic happened. Distance remained distance. I did not invent a future that the journey could not support. Still, the memory endured because a voice had turned a famous place into a specific human moment.

That is the difference between reaching a landmark and arriving in one's own life.

14. Thailand, Cambodia, and the Price of a Ride

Thailand was not a short stop. I travelled for roughly two and a half to three weeks across different regions: north, west, the eastern Gulf side and the south. Bangkok, Pattaya, Phuket, the route toward the Phi Phi Islands and the crossing into Cambodia each carried a different rhythm.

Pattaya left me comparatively neutral. Other places opened more strongly. In the south, transport often began with a repeated question: did I want a ride? Usually the offer had a price. That was not wrong; it was the local economy making itself explicit.

Once, on the way toward a pier for Phi Phi, I was walking through an unfamiliar area with many dogs. A local person stopped and offered to take me to the pier. This time no price followed. My impression was that he had read the situation before I had and decided that help mattered more than negotiation.

I cannot prove what he thought. I remember the difference in tone.

The Cambodia excursion was compressed almost beyond reason. I arrived around midnight, obtained a visa at the border or arrival threshold with far less preparation than my European bureaucratic instincts expected, negotiated with a tuk-tuk driver in Siem Reap, visited Angkor and returned toward an airport by late afternoon. The exact route still needs confirmation, and I refuse to make the geography cleaner than memory.

What remains clear is the structure: every stage required a new handoff. Border official, driver, ticket, agreed return, another vehicle, another clock. The temples offered scale and silence; the people made the day possible.

15. Moscow, Saint Petersburg, and an Open Gate

Russia required a different kind of preparation. From Budapest, I needed an invitation for the visa. A travel agency near Oktogon and Andrássy Avenue helped arrange it. One office redirected me to another, and another toward the embassy. The absence of an ordinary appointment route made the visa cost several times what I had expected.

Then I arrived and did not know how to buy the bus ticket.

A Russian passenger used a monthly pass to let me through into the passenger area. I had crossed the formal border with documents, fees and repeated instructions. The final small gate opened because an ordinary person saw me standing on the wrong side of it.

Moscow and Saint Petersburg offered opposite scales. Moscow felt radial and monumental: broad approaches, walls, squares and movement arranged around power. Saint Petersburg opened horizontally through water, façades, bridges and the long light of the north. The cities were historically immense. The memory that best explains the journey is still the smallest: somebody tapped a pass.

16. Europe Within Reach

From Budapest, Europe often began before dawn at a coach pickup point.

Some journeys lasted only a day. Their brevity did not make them trivial. A bus created a temporary group: strangers, couples, a guide, a schedule, a fixed number of seats and a promise to return by night.

In Slovakia, the High Tatras rose beyond forest and weather. Memories around Starý Smokovec, Hrebienok, Štrbské Pleso and Tatranská Lomnica remain candidates to be confirmed against images. What I remember most clearly is the change in scale when the bus stopped: the timetable remained human-sized while the mountain did not.

Austria contains several separate journeys in my memory. Vienna includes Schönbrunn—palace geometry, gardens and the Gloriette holding the city at a distance. Another route reached Klagenfurt and Minimundus near Lake Wörthersee, where the world is rebuilt in miniature. It was a strangely appropriate place for somebody who would later attempt to model complicated human systems: whole countries reduced to objects small enough to walk around, their differences preserved through detail.

The Bärenschützklamm was not Vienna and not a palace. Near Mixnitz in Styria, water and rock were crossed through a long construction of bridges and wooden ladders. Progress became physical and cooperative. Every person had a pace; every narrow section required awareness of the person ahead and behind.

Croatia and Slovenia added other one-day or short-route memories: Zagreb's squares and blue trams, the possibility of Plitvice's boardwalks and layered water, Ljubljana's river and bridges, and the Bled or Vintgar landscape. The exact historic combinations must still be confirmed. I would rather preserve

separate honest images than create one impossible itinerary.

These bus journeys later became a useful product metaphor. A complete event is not only a destination. It is members, capacity, transport, timing, place, supplies, tickets, weather and the right to say no. A person who cannot attend should not destroy the relationship or the plan. Another person may choose the open place. By the time the bus returns, strangers may have become people who can invite one another again.

17. Empty Beds, Empty Seats, Perfect Systems

Some journeys were beautiful without producing a personal story, and that absence became part of the story.

Italy gave me what I remember as my most beautiful route: rail from Bergamo toward Naples, with the exact intermediate sequence still to be confirmed. Landscape and city changed at high speed while the train held a continuous interior around them.

In Paris, I travelled as if following a compass. On different days I chose different directions: the city itself, Versailles, Disneyland Paris and routes beyond the centre. Paris was not empty of sights. The problem was deciding which direction a limited day could contain.

From Bergen, a coordinated chain of rail, the Flåm Railway, fjord boat, bus and rail is the strongest candidate for the Norwegian circuit I remember. Each vehicle arrived to continue a route designed by people I never met. The system worked so well that it almost disappeared.

On a ferry toward Rotterdam, I booked what I remember as an approximately ten-berth cabin and occupied it alone. In Spain, a roughly three-bed hostel or university room also became private by chance. Beds existed. Compatible people did not appear merely because capacity did.

Porto and Lisbon formed a four-day contrast: granite and the Douro, then hills, light and the Tagus. Neuschwanstein rose like an image already familiar before arrival. Bavaria, the Netherlands, Belgium and the eastern United States added other waters, cities and routes. Niagara, Chesapeake, Ocean City, Baltimore, Washington—some locations remain sharper than their chronology.

In Istanbul, I was invited inside for tea and a carpet presentation. Hospitality and commerce unfolded together. The welcome could be genuine and the sales purpose real. Context prevented either interpretation from cancelling the other. Dubai then offered another scale: creek and dhow, vertical glass and roads built around distance.

Travel taught me that infrastructure can move a body with astonishing efficiency. It cannot decide who will share the cabin, the table, the story or the next journey.

18. When the World Closed

After I returned to Budapest in December 2015, I did not immediately return to Hungarian institutional life. For roughly three years, I did not register again with the Hungarian public-health-insurance system. I felt almost invisible: in the country physically, but not fully inside its ordinary administrative or social rhythm.

The later Brexit rupture added to my sense that the old connection between my British and Hungarian lives had become harder to read. I cannot responsibly claim that Brexit made my location administratively impossible to verify. What I can say is that I experienced those years as existing outside the view of the systems that had previously defined work, coverage and belonging.

This was also when many of the longest journeys became possible. Full-time work had made that duration almost impossible. Now I travelled, looked for a partner, tried every route I could think of and returned to private creative work. The freedom was real, but so was the doubt. The leap year of 2016 became a suspended year in my own chronology: I kept asking whether I had made a brave decision or a terrible mistake.

I wanted to preserve independence from a country I felt had betrayed me. Yet complete separation did not become a life either. On 10 November 2018, I gave Hungary a second chance: I registered again with the health-insurance system and began looking for work. Until that threshold, I had been searching for a partner and travelling through the world while remaining emotionally outside Hungarian society.

Then the world closed.

COVID did not make travel impossible forever, and I will not claim that nobody can travel as before. For me, it ended the earlier feeling of carelessness. The open route was no longer innocent. Borders, health, cancellation and uncertainty became visible inside every plan.

The change clarified something that had already been forming. I loved movement, but I did not want to spend my life only passing through. I had learned to enter new countries. I had not learned how to make human continuity survive the journey.

Beauty had given me memories. Local people had made those memories alive. What I still lacked was a way for an encounter to become part of a shared future.

MYSCOUTEE ORIGIN STORY

Part Four — Rooms Full of Beginnings

19. I Came Home to Find a Partner

I had gone abroad to earn money.

I came home to find a partner.

The sentence sounds cleaner than the life around it. Returning was not a single moment in which the suitcase touched the floor and every intention became clear. Between December 2015 and 10 November 2018, partner-seeking, travel, private creative work and doubt occupied the same suspended interval. Only then did I begin consciously re-entering the country's ordinary working and institutional life. Foreign experience did not automatically create a place for me in the labour market or society. People could read the same years abroad as courage, instability, high expectations, failure, ambition or a sign that I might leave again. I could not know which story another person had already written about me.

Age also became more visible. In my own experience, it had felt less decisive abroad. At home, I increasingly felt that a number could stand in front of the person. I do not claim that age discrimination is uniquely Hungarian or absent elsewhere. It exists across labour markets and inside digital dating. My point is personal: by the time I reached the room, somebody could already believe the most important fact about me was how many years I had lived.

Still, I tried.

I tried because I had not returned to observe my life from behind the window. I wanted a person with whom the journeys, work, ordinary evenings and future could be shared.

20. Two Kinds of Silence

I joined the apps.

Online dating contains real possibility. People meet, form relationships and build lives through it. My own experience also exposed two opposite failures of attention.

On one side, a person sends interest and waits inside silence. The phone remains still long enough for the stillness to become a verdict.

On the other side, a person receives so many messages that individual intention loses shape. Attention becomes a crowd. Reading everything requires time, filtering and safety work. Overload can look like abundance from the outside and feel like another form of impossibility from within.

Neither person is morally wrong. The system places scarcity and excess beside each other without building a bridge between them.

A photograph carries enormous weight. Age, appearance and fragments of history arrive before a voice, before a shared task, before we have seen how somebody listens, adapts, jokes, helps or respects a boundary. We form an opinion because the interface asks for one. The opinion can feel complete because no shared context exists to contradict it.

The old world was not automatically kinder. Introductions through friends could exclude, gossip and reproduce closed circles. A person in common could be wrong. Nostalgia is not a product requirement.

What I missed was the useful human function inside an introduction: context before verdict.

21. Rooms Full of Beginnings

I did not remain behind the phone.

I went to talks, community dinners, language and social evenings, exhibitions, events and other rooms where people had chosen to appear in public. Each room contained beginnings. A short conversation could be pleasant, intelligent and genuine. Then the event ended, the crowd changed, and the beginning had no supported next step.

This did not mean the events had failed. A lecture is allowed to be a lecture. A volunteer group is not a dating market. A person attending a cultural evening has not consented to be evaluated romantically. The problem was not that every door should lead to a relationship. The problem was that, when two or more people did want continuation, the structure often disappeared exactly when it became necessary.

Who asks? How is mutual intention expressed without public embarrassment? What happens when somebody is interested but unavailable? Where do people meet? Who chooses the place, checks the time, manages the route and gives everybody a clear way to decline?

We have many systems for discovery. We have fewer systems for continuation.

22. The Beginner Floor

Dance classes gave me another version of the same lesson.

At the beginner level, the floor was full. People missed steps, recovered, laughed and changed partners because the instructor had made movement between strangers legitimate. The shared task carried conversation. Nobody needed to invent a reason to stand near another person; the music and the lesson had already created one.

At the advanced level, the room thinned. Novelty had passed. Schedules, difficulty and other priorities reduced the group.

Sometimes a conversation with a woman began warmly. Then her partner arrived, folded an umbrella and greeted us. The context became clear. Nothing terrible happened. Nobody had deceived or humiliated me. I adjusted, smiled and stepped back.

The lesson was not that partnered people had occupied the wrong room. The lesson was that context arrived late.

Dance showed what an app profile could not: rhythm, patience, humour, recovery after error, comfort with proximity and respect for another person's movement. It also showed that shared activity is not the same as romantic availability.

A better path would need both truths at once.

23. The Wrong Room for a Date

Dates happened too.

Sometimes the person was not the problem. The room was.

In a loud café, an espresso machine could erase the most important half of a sentence. In a basement bar, music turned conversation into repeated apology: “Sorry—what did you say?” At an elegant restaurant, a beautiful table could make two ordinary people sit as if they were being examined. Visible prices, interruptions and formal duration gave a first meeting the weight of a final decision.

The opposite side of a city could consume more time than the date itself. Weather could destroy a scenic plan with no fallback. A skill-based activity could give one person confidence and the other an hour of public failure.

Chemistry does not occur outside logistics. Light, noise, cost, travel, timing, alcohol, accessibility, weather and the ability to leave all shape the meeting.

This became another MyScoutee principle: the platform behind a meeting cannot stop at identifying people. It must carry them toward a context in which they can actually meet.

24. A Whole Person Behind the Frame

By then I had tried enough doors to stop blaming the existence of doors.

Apps offered reach. Events offered presence. Dance offered shared action. Travel offered openness. Friends of friends offered context. Each route contained real value. Each lost continuity at a different boundary.

The common failure appeared on the notebook page.

Before meeting, we reduced one another to filters: age, appearance, biography, distance, a short sentence, a delayed reply. After meeting, a person became three-dimensional again. We could see how somebody treated a waiter, waited for a slower walker, solved a practical problem, spoke when nervous, listened when another person needed space, and changed when the plan changed.

A picture is powerful. It is also thin.

The whole person includes difficulty. Housing insecurity, money, distance, health, age, fear and past disappointment do not automatically disqualify somebody from relationship. MyScoutee should not classify imperfect people out of view. Its more modest purpose is to create enough reciprocal context and shared reality for people to see whether acceptance, boundaries and mutual effort can carry them through problems together.

I have come to believe that most people are not asking to be declared flawless. They are asking not to be reduced to the first visible problem before anybody knows them. They want acceptance: not automatic approval of every action, and not the surrender of another person's safety or boundaries, but the chance to be seen as a whole human being. Only then can two people decide freely whether they can continue together.

Acceptance and speed are not opposites. We do not have infinite time. An online dating system must filter, or people remain inside an endless catalogue and an unmanageable queue of conversations. The humane question is not whether to filter. It is what the filter decides.

I did not want to hide age or pretend that preferences do not exist. MyScoutee is not age-blind, and it cannot abolish prejudice. I wanted older adults to remain full participants rather than disappear from the visual and social field. Age could remain truthful context without becoming the public value of a human being.

The product did not need to tell people whom to love.

It needed to give mutual intention somewhere real to go.

MYSCOUTEE ORIGIN STORY

Part Five — Drawing the Path

25. The Idea from 2016

The idea that became MyScoutee dates to 2016.

It did not arrive as a finished interface or a sudden revelation generated by a machine. It accumulated through years of observation: crowded houses, unmatched capacity, short-lived travel networks, silent phones, overloaded phones, rooms full of beginnings, late-arriving context and plans that failed because one person lacked one day.

Back in Budapest, I gave long periods of my life to creative work in private. From the December 2015 return until the 10 November 2018 re-entry threshold, I withdrew far enough that the work became almost invisible from outside. I travelled, searched for a partner, returned, opened the notebook and kept trying to give the problem a form. The 2016 idea belongs inside this period of chosen independence, uncertainty and unfinished return.

That independence mattered because MyScoutee could not have been built in the fragments left beside an ordinary full-time job. The idea has now occupied a long span of calendar time, but I did not spend ten continuous years developing it. What financial independence gave me was something more precise: the right to create sustained periods of attention. Without it, even the concentrated weeks needed to turn the idea into a broad system would not have been available.

The problem was not “How do I create another dating app?”

It was:

> *How can a relationship travel from unknown possibility to a real meeting, while every person keeps the right to decide?*

That question is harder than matching two profiles. It includes intention, reciprocity, capacity, context, conversation, place, transport, resources, attendance, memory and change over time.

Later, artificial intelligence accelerated implementation. It helped me work at a speed that made a broad software core possible. It did not invent the human insight. It did not validate the product, produce a community or prove that the system improves relationships. Faster construction is not the same as evidence.

The notebook still had to meet the world.

26. Priority Is Not Human Value

The first product decision is deliberately private.

A user can give an unknown individual or pair an editable priority from one to ten. The number is not attractiveness, morality, reputation or public human value. It is a statement about the user's current willingness to allocate scarce attention.

Binary choice hides important differences. Curiosity is not the same as strong interest. Strong interest is not the same as present capacity. A person may care and still lack time. A person may become more or less interested as context changes.

The priority can change because people change.

Personal intuition remains part of the system after the screen becomes a real meeting. A first encounter may confirm an earlier impression, weaken it or make somebody newly important. Each participant can privately raise or lower the relevant rates as experience develops. The system therefore does not preserve one frozen match; future affinity and group opportunities can be recalculated from evolving human input and context.

No single person's rating determines the next meeting. Other people's private inputs, reciprocity, availability, distance and a fresh accept-or-decline choice still matter. The algorithm proposes a changing path through shared intention; it does not issue a social verdict.

Automated or contextual signals may contribute, but they do not override consent. A strong preference from one person cannot pull another person into a group. Nobody is owed a meeting. Every invitation still requires an independent decision.

This matters because software is tempted to make its own calculation look more important than the humans inside it. MyScoutee should not display a giant graph declaring compatibility. The mechanism belongs in the background. Faces, choices and real meetings belong in front.

MyScoutee is built to be a rapid filter, but not a rapid verdict on human worth. Private priority, reciprocity, distance and context can narrow the field quickly enough to ask whether a small candidate group is worth offering. Independent acceptance then moves willing people toward chat and a real meeting instead of keeping them inside infinite browsing.

The machine accelerates the path to human context. It does not replace the human decision that becomes possible there. Whether this produces better outcomes still has to be tested with real communities.

27. Six Strangers

In the clearest form of the story, the system proposes a balanced candidate group of six strangers: three women and three men.

The group is not an accidental presentation layer. It changes the risk carried by the meeting. A two-person date can place the entire value of an evening on one immediate romantic outcome. If chemistry does not appear, both people may experience the time as wasted. A group can support several conversations, a shared activity, future friendship or another invitation even when one possible pair does not continue.

A larger group also makes more kinds of real-world activity practical. People can share a place, transport, supplies, cost, knowledge and responsibility. The event has a purpose larger than evaluating one person across a table.

They are not six copies of one desirable profile. They differ in age, body, ethnicity, temperament, clothing and expectation. The initial group spans adults from their thirties into their early fifties; later events can include people in their sixties with the same agency and visual weight. No one is cast as an “older user” whose only role is to prove inclusion.

Before the meeting, each person carries a separate inner world. One imagines a book. Another a shared meal. Another music, a route, a tabletop game or a place to sketch. A candidate group does not mean they are already friends. It means there is enough reciprocal intention and context to ask a better question.

Each person receives an invitation. Each may accept or decline without public punishment.

If the group proceeds, separate panels become a contextual group chat. The chat is not the destination. It is the preparation for a doorway.

At that doorway, the six introduce themselves.

The product's most important transformation is not a swipe becoming a match. It is a stranger becoming somebody who has actually been met.

28. The First Managed Event

A real event needs more than a title.

The current MyScoutee core can organize the people, transport, place or accommodation, and supplies required for a plan. Tickets, check-in and feedback remain separate actions. The distinction sounds technical until something is missing.

Who is coming? How will they travel? Is the venue appropriate? Who has the key? What must be brought? Does somebody need a ticket? Did the person actually arrive? What did the participants experience afterward?

The event should be public enough to feel legible, hosted enough to feel intentional and flexible enough to let a person leave. A quiet conversation area matters. So does a visible entrance. Accessibility should be designed into the route rather than reduced to an invented pictogram.

The six strangers contribute to a shared task. One checks transport. One confirms the place. One brings supplies. Two discover a joke. One listens before speaking. The Founder is part of the group, not its centre.

Nothing guarantees romance. That is not failure.

If six people meet, learn enough to recognize one another and choose whether to continue, the system has carried intention into reality. Chemistry finally has somewhere to happen—or not happen—without asking one stranger to justify the entire evening.

29. After Strangers Become Known

After the first meeting, the product state should change because the human state has changed.

Every real encounter returns new information to the people who were present. Their personal intuitions can become private rate changes: up after trust, interest or an unexpectedly good conversation; down after discomfort, disagreement or a sense that continuation would not be right. Those evolving inputs help determine dynamically which future group or event paths become more or less likely.

These are no longer abstract profiles. They are known contacts with a place and time in common. They can be invited directly to later events. A person in common or a previous event can make the next invitation less cold without becoming a public character reference or guarantee of safety.

If one person lacks time and declines, an available place may be offered through the priority plan. The next person still chooses independently. People are not replacement parts; capacity is allowed to change without destroying the social path.

The planner and Auto Inviter are designed to move an accepted plan back toward its intended capacity. They can offer an open place to another suitable person instead of making one absence collapse the whole event. The design target is a complete group, not a guarantee that every place will always be filled. No algorithm can manufacture availability or consent.

Repeated meetings may become community. Community is the result, not the input.

Relationships may also weaken. An ordinary disagreement can lower one private priority and make a future shared route less likely. No revenge score follows. No public reputation is damaged. The network remembers context without becoming gossip.

This is a living social graph, not a completed matching result. A person may meet somebody again, meet one of that person's known contacts, or enter a different balanced group as private rates and real availability change. Every new proposal still ends in independent human consent.

The whole life of a relationship matters: unknown person, private intention, reciprocal group, conversation, first meeting, known contact, later invitation, repetition, change.

Most systems celebrate the beginning. Human life continues after it.

30. One Shared Core, Many Local Souls

My travels taught me that global reach without local meaning is only movement.

MyScoutee therefore should not become one central culture distributed around the world. The core problem may be shared: how do mutual intention and available capacity become a real meeting? The answer still belongs to local people.

Localization means more here than translating labels. The current core can use distance and location context and can carry an event through a real place, transport, timing and other resources. The operator model adds another local layer: language, culture, venues, boundaries, partnerships and community knowledge. It does not make geography disappear or claim to replace a complete travel planner. A few-hour Debrecen–Budapest date can still depend on two timetables and one narrow window. The product's task is to make that constraint visible early enough to coordinate a humane plan.

Changing countries makes speed more important. A person arrives with finite time and often without a usable local network. The MyScoutee ambition is that the same group-first path can be available again under a new city's language, places, culture and operator, so relocation does not require inventing the route to human context from nothing.

The present architecture does not yet provide a seamless passport carrying a person's profile, chats, contacts and private rate history between independent operators. Those records remain local, and identity migration is later work. The honest current promise is continuity of method, not automatic movement of private history. A local network can be built faster; it still has to be built with new consent.

A technically capable local operator can run the shared core on an independently hosted server, under a local brand, with local communities, venues, activities, language, cultural knowledge and responsibility. Operators may cooperate through a voluntary network and shared infrastructure. They must also retain a credible opt-out that leaves the local deployment operable.

The common core should reduce duplicated technical effort. It should not erase local authorship.

A city walk in Budapest, a dance-linked group in London, a one-day coach toward the High Tatras, a community table in Lisbon or a cultural event in Cairo cannot be made meaningful by the same visual template alone. Local organizers know the pace, boundaries, costs, trust signals, transport and places. Participants create the actual event through their decisions.

Global route. Local encounter.

The principle returns at the end because it was present from the beginning.

31. What Is Built, What Is Not Proven

The software core is broad. It contains private priorities, contextual and reciprocal group planning, invitations, chat, events, schedules, policies, resources, ticket and check-in paths, feedback, notifications, moderation, administration, branding and operator controls.

Breadth is not traction.

Code does not prove that strangers will accept a proposal, attend the event, feel comfortable, return or form relationships. It does not prove improved safety, superior matching, revenue or product-market fit.

The next work is less cinematic and more important: performance and mobile hardening, safety and privacy review, real-world testing, one dense pilot, measurement from proposal through acceptance, chat, event, attendance and feedback, and a launch process that a local operator can repeat.

That requires partners:

- technically capable local operators;
- pilot communities willing to test the complete path;
- product collaborators;
- venue, activity, travel and experience partners;
- later strategic partners who understand the difference between built scope and proven outcomes.

I am not looking for somebody to admire the notebook.

I am looking for people willing to test the path.

Epilogue — The Star Above the Open Space

The MyScoutee mark contains a helmet-like shelter, a star and an open human space at its centre.

I do not treat it as a guarantee. A logo cannot certify safety, direction or connection. It can only hold an intention.

When I close the cognac notebook, the routes do not disappear. The field row is still inside the rail line. Budapest is still beautiful. The hostel corridor, the London window, the shared bedroom, the one-pound coach, the fallen luggage, the balloon in the vegetable plot, the bus voice behind me in Agra, the Russian passenger's card, the local ride to the pier, the bridges inside the gorge and the six chairs around a real table remain connected by memory.

For years, I believed the central problem was finding the right person.

Now I believe the world already contains more possible connection than we can see. The missing element is often the path: context before verdict, intention without public humiliation, coordination without coercion, memory without gossip, and enough local humanity to turn a route into a meeting.

The path cannot manufacture acceptance. It can give acceptance a fairer chance to become mutual, informed and real.

My story does not end with a perfect match.

It ends with an invitation.

MyScoutee. Test it with me in real communities.

MYSCOUTEE ORIGIN STORY

Notes on Memory, Geography, and Product Truth

This section is intentionally separate from the memoir voice. It records the main public sources and truth boundaries used for this review edition.

Budapest and Its Surroundings

- The Banks of the Danube, Buda Castle District and Andrássy Avenue form Budapest's UNESCO-listed urban landscape.
- Official Budapest cultural material supports the presence of the Hungarian National Gallery, Museum of Fine Arts, National Museum, Ludwig Museum, Kunsthalle, thermal baths, caves and the Zugliget Chairlift.
- Official Greater Budapest material supports Szentendre, Visegrád, Esztergom and Gödöllő as credible nearby day-trip anchors.

Sources:

- https://whc.unesco.org/en/list/400/
- https://visithungary.com/articles/budapest-you_re-wonderful
- https://www.budapestinfo.hu/en/spring-exhibition-guide-in-budapest
- https://visithungary.com/articles/visegrad-citadel
- https://visithungary.com/trip/greater-budapest-for-explorers---1-day

Thiruvananthapuram and the First India Assignment

- Thiruvananthapuram is also known as Trivandrum. Official district material places Kerala's capital near the extreme south of India's west coast, across low coastal hills beside the Arabian Sea.
- Kerala Tourism places the Western Ghats/highlands to the east and northeast and documents a district containing coastline, backwaters and both prominent and quieter beach environments.
- The cornfield hiring moment, roughly six-week assignment, Irish–Hungarian team, development of practical English and nearly tourist-free visited beach are first-person memories. The exact company, campus and beach are not named.
- “Practically no tourists” describes the particular shoreline the Founder remembers. It does not mean that the district lacked tourism; official sources document well-known visitor beaches elsewhere in the same district.

Sources:

- https://trivandrum.nic.in/en/about-district/
- https://www.keralatourism.org/districts/thiruvananthapuram/

- https://trivandrum.nic.in/en/places-of-interest/
- https://spb.kerala.gov.in/economic-review/ER2012/Chapter5/chapter05.html

London, Migration, and Return

- The exact household, lunch, work, housing and journey details are first-person memories.
- The United States geography is deliberately bounded. Official Washington material supports Adams Morgan as a diverse, socially active neighbourhood; National Park Service material supports the Appalachian mountain/park corridor west of Washington; Maryland tourism material supplies amusement- park recognition candidates. None of those sources verifies the Founder's personal encounters or exact itinerary.
- Ocean City's state, the exact Amish area, amusement park, hotel and protected landscapes remain unconfirmed. The public narrative therefore uses only the names the Founder remembers and avoids a false reconstructed route.
- The United States assignment, promised-but-unreceived overtime payment, departure, six-and-a-half-month unemployment period, final four-round Hungarian interview and London job within two weeks are also first-person memories. Employers remain anonymous, and the account makes no legal finding.
- The health chronology is first-person testimony: blood in the Founder's stool appeared during the American period's extreme work pressure; he associated it with that pressure; he moved to London in 2011 while still experiencing it; his Hungarian public-health-insurance coverage was no longer active; and he received medical care in London. No diagnosis, clinical detail, independent causation finding or comparative health-system claim is made.
- London begins in 2011. The Diamond Jubilee and Olympic summer belong to 2012, the following year, and are preserved as atmosphere rather than an arrival date.
- Practical English beginning in Trivandrum and weak conversational English in early London are compatible: the Founder reports that he could barely speak with colleagues for almost three years despite being able to perform the job.
- The impression that perhaps one person in three around the household no longer wanted to return is explicitly not a population statistic.
- Research on return migration shows mixed experiences: foreign experience and language may be valued, while skill mismatch, weakened networks and employer stereotypes can also exist. No specific employer motive is asserted here.

Sources:

- https://washington.org/dc-neighborhoods/adams-morgan
- https://www.nps.gov/planyourvisit/cities.htm
- https://www.nps.gov/subjects/mountains/explore.htm

- https://www.visitmaryland.org/list/roller-coasters
- https://www.nps.gov/appa/planyourvisit/upload/APPA_Map.pdf
- https://a.storyblok.com/f/279033/86106655bd/ef1243en.pdf
- https://www.oecd.org/content/dam/oecd/en/publications/reports/2020/10/sustainable-reintegration-of-returning-migrants_86be9bc5/5fee55b3-en.pdf
- https://ojs.mtak.hu/index.php/hungeobull/article/view/595

Selected Journey Anchors

- The North Wales low-tide village remains unconfirmed; Llanfairfechan is the strongest current candidate.
- The Egypt trip occurred after the London homecoming, so the memoir groups journeys thematically rather than claiming a strict film chronology.
- Specific monuments not clearly remembered remain candidates rather than asserted visits.
- Minimundus is in Klagenfurt near Lake Wörthersee, not Vienna.
- Bärenschützklamm begins near Mixnitz in Styria. Official tourism material describes the route's bridges, ladders, waterfalls and demanding elevation.

Sources:

- https://www.visitconwy.org.uk/explore/towns-and-villages/llanfairfechan/
- https://www.minimundus.at/en/
- https://www.minimundus.at/en/location-how-to-get-here/
- https://www.steiermark.com/en/Oststeiermark/Plan-your-holiday/Tours/Through-the-Barenschutzklamm-from-Mixnitz_tour_30999545
- https://www.schoenbrunn.at/en/
- https://whc.unesco.org/en/list/87
- https://systemhealth.rbi.org.in/Scripts/BS_PressReleaseDisplay.aspx_prid%3D38520%281%29.html

Age and Digital Dating

- Age discrimination is not presented as uniquely Hungarian or absent abroad.
- MyScoutee does not hide age and does not claim to solve ageism. The bounded product principle is continued agency and context before premature verdict.

Sources:

- https://op.europa.eu/webpub/empl/lmwd-annual-review-report-2024/chapter3/the-labour-force-participation-and-employment.html
- https://www.uoc.edu/en/news/2024/digital-ageism-on-dating-apps

Product Claims

The product descriptions in this book are based on the current MyScoutee repository and pitch materials. Built scope is not evidence of users, revenue, retention, safety improvement, relationship outcomes, deployed operators or product-market fit. The operator network is an intended model to be tested.

Unpublished review draft. Prepared for story, factual and visual-continuity review before character and video-model benchmarking. The build reads the current edition version from `version.json`.